

Now I could not unmount Lilo from MBR. When trying to update to Windows Me failed to solve the problem. Norton Antivirus 2001 detected a change in the MBR and prompted for cleaning it. I chose Yes, but now on restarting I get only a prompt for 'Li' and my system hangs. I can boot using the Linux boot floppy, but how do I recover the Windows partition?

G.Kalyana Sundaram

Via e-mail

R This is quite a simple process. Boot from the Windows Startup disk and run fdisk /mbr at the command prompt. This will replace the Master Boot Record with the Windows boot loader instead of the Linux Loader.

None of the data on the hard disk will be affected. In rare cases, this does not help. In such a case, you will have to remove and recreate the partition using fdisk. However, you must first copy all the data to another disk. You can do this by installing the hard disk on another PC that boots from a different disk.

Internet & Communication

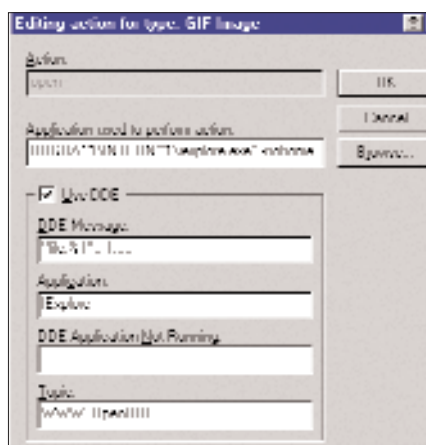
■ A gift for GIF

My Internet Explorer behaves peculiarly in that it displays JPG images but is not able to display GIF images. I even check the Internet Options > Advanced > Multimedia, but to no avail. Please suggest a remedy.

Samuel Praveen gathala

Via e-mail

R This usually happens when the file type gets associated with another program. Open Start > Settings > Folder Options and



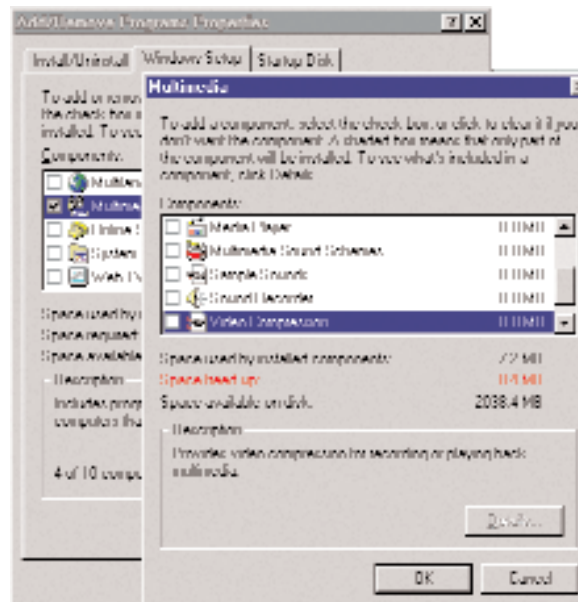
Edit the file extensions

edit the GIF File Type. Ensure that Content Type (MIME) is image/gif. Delete all actions except for open and edit this action. Under the Application used to perform action, enter "C:\PROGRA~1\INTERN~1\IEXPLORE.EXE" -nohome (assuming that Internet Explorer is installed in C:\Program Files\Internet Explorer. Enable Use DDE and under DDE message, enter "file:%1", -1,,,,,. Under Application, enter IExplore, leave DDE Application Not Running blank and enter WWW_OpenURL under Topic.

Applications

■ Missing the movies

On my P-II machine with 128 MB RAM and running Win98, I was able to watch movies comfortably in all formats. But recently, I have a problem watching VCDs (dat files) on my machine using Windows Media Player or Xing



Install the right video codecs

Player. I have no problem opening AVI files. I tried installing and uninstalling both Media Player and Xing and also tried replacing the Msvideo.dll, Mciavi.drv and Dciman.dll files through the sfc utility for checking and replacing damaged Windows system files. But even after this, I am not able to run VCDs. Even copying these files from the Windows setup directory didn't help. Is there any alternative other than formatting?

Umesh

Via e-mail

R Most probably, the video Codecs (the software that understands the file format) are corrupted or missing. Uninstalling either of the applications would normally not remove the codecs and hence reinstalling does not replace them. Uninstall Media Player and Xing, then delete the folders where they were installed. Next,

open Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup and remove Video Compression from the details of the Multimedia item. Also remove Media Player from here. Restart your machine and check Control Panel > Multimedia > Devices > Video Compression Codecs.

If any of the old codecs are still listed here, remove them manually by clicking on Properties.

Now follow the above process in reverse, installing Video Compression and Media Player from Add/Remove Programs, followed by Media Player 7 and Xing. The VCDs should play now ■

Writing in to SOS

If you are writing in about a problem you are facing with your computer please make sure you send us the following information:

- Which operating system do you use?
- Which processor do you have?
- How much RAM do you have installed?

In addition to this, provide us with information that is specific to the problem that you are facing. For example, list the error messages if a program is crashing, or graphics card specifications when games don't run properly on your system. If possible, send a screenshot of the error message that you get.

DO YOU NEED HELP?

Send an SOS to sos@jasubhai.com

Or write in to DIGIT, D-222/2, Om Sagar Bldg, MIDC, Nerul-400 706